

Global Employee Policy Handbook

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Applicability: All Full-Time Global Employees

1. International Travel Policy

1.1 Scope and Objectives

This policy establishes guidelines and procedures for employees undertaking international travel on behalf of the company. It balances operational efficiency, cost management, and employee safety during global business engagements.

1.2 Authorization Process

All international travel requires written pre-approval before booking any arrangements:

- **Pre-Approval Form:** Submit a request through the internal portal 30 days before departure.
- **Management Approval:** Line managers must approve the business justification and destination.
- **Budget Check:** The finance department must sign off on the estimated itinerary costs.

1.3 Booking and Expenses

Employees must use the company's corporate travel platform to book flights, accommodations, and transportation.

- **Air Travel:** Economy class is the standard for flights under 6 hours. Premium economy may be requested for continuous flights exceeding 6 hours.
- **Lodging:** Booking must be made at preferred partner hotels. Room rates must not exceed the standard city per-diem limits.
- **Meals and Incidentals:** Covered up to \$75 USD per day. Receipts are mandatory for all individual items over \$25 USD.

1.4 Duty of Care and Safety

Employee safety is the company's highest priority during global travel:

- **Travel Insurance:** Automated corporate global medical insurance activates upon booking approval.
 - **Emergency Check-ins:** Employees must respond to check-in notifications from HR within 4 hours during unexpected local crises.
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2. Vacation and Paid Time Off (PTO) Policy

2.1 Scope and Objectives

The company believes that rest and relaxation are vital for productivity and personal well-being. This policy sets out the rules governing vacation accrual, requests, and usage.

2.2 Annual Allotment and Accrual

- **Standard Allotment:** Full-time employees receive 20 days of paid vacation per calendar year.
- **Accrual Rate:** Vacation time accrues monthly at a rate of 1.66 days per completed month of service.
- **Carry-Over Rules:** A maximum of 5 unused vacation days can be carried into the next calendar year. These days must be used by March 31st or they are forfeited.

2.3 Booking Vacation Time

Advanced planning prevents team disruption and ensures continuous business coverage:

- **Notice Required:** Submit requests 2 weeks in advance for time off lasting less than 5 days. Submit 1 month in advance for time off lasting 5 consecutive days or more.
- **Approval Tool:** All requests must go through the HR information system.
- **Coverage Plan:** Employees must outline a peer-coverage plan for critical tasks before departure.

2.4 Unused Leave and Separation

Vacation days cannot be exchanged for additional cash compensation during active employment. Upon separation from the company, accrued and unused vacation time will be paid out in the final paycheck, subject to local labor regulations.
